Incident Report: New Account

Date/time	10/08/2026 / 21:55
Analyst	SD
Severity	High
Status	Closed (lab)

Summary

A new local user account, backdoor-test, was created on the lab endpoint to simulate an attacker establishing persistence after gaining access. Wazuh detected the account creation and generated a high-severity alert.

Detection

Tool	Wazuh
Rule ID and description	5902 - New user added to the system.
Alert time	21:55

Timeline

Time	Event
21:55	backdoor-test account created on endpoint via adduser
21:55	Wazuh rule 5902 triggered on new user creation

Evidence

Image 1: Terminal output on the endpoint showing the backdoor-test account creation that triggered the alert.

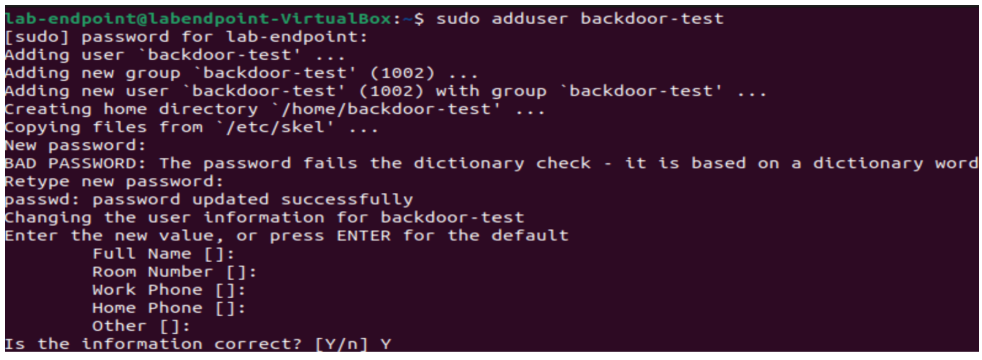
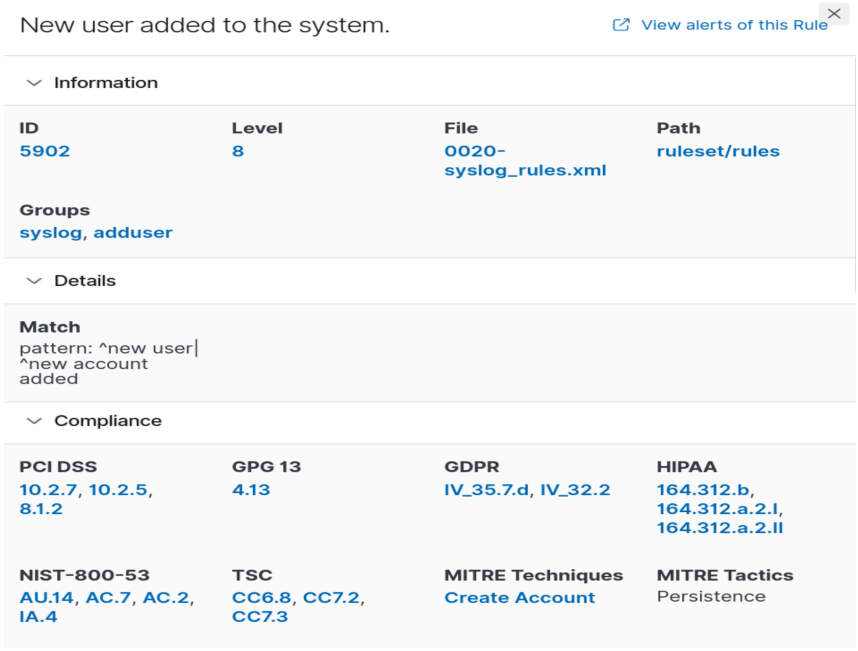


Image 2: Wazuh alert detail for rule 5902, confirming detection at level 8 with MITRE ATT&CK Persistence / Create Account mapping, and compliance mapping to PCI DSS, NIST 800-53, GDPR, and HIPAA.



MITRE ATT&CK

Tactic	Persistence
Technique	T1136.001 Create Account: Local Account

Analysis

This is a **true positive**. Creating an unauthorized account is a common persistence technique, and Wazuh flagged it at level 8, correctly treating it as higher severity than a simple login failure. This reflects real attacker behavior: once inside a system, adding an account is a way to maintain access even if the original entry point is closed.

This alert also maps to recognized compliance frameworks, including NIST 800-53 (AU-14, AC-7, AC-2, IA-4) and PCI DSS (10.2.5, 10.2.7, 8.1.2), both of which require monitoring and logging of account creation activity. This shows the detection isn't just a SOC-level alert, it directly supports audit and compliance reporting requirements.

Response Recommendations

Immediate action	Investigate the account immediately and disable or remove it if unauthorized
Long-term fix	Alert on any new local account creation outside of a documented change window, and restrict adduser/useradd to specific admin accounts

Lessons Learned

Wazuh's default rule correctly escalated this to a higher severity than the brute force alert, which matches real-world risk, persistence is generally more dangerous than a failed login attempt.